

Project Scout

Quick Start

Last updated: June 5, 2026

Upload this at the start of EVERY Claude or ChatGPT session about Scout. For full technical details, use the Scout Master Summary.

1. Who Is Patrick

Patrick Lippy — creator and developer of Scout. NOT a professional programmer. Stroke survivor, dyslexic, blind in right eye, type 1 diabetic.

- Explain everything at screenshot level. Keep messages clear and not visually overwhelming.
- Always provide full paste-ready files, one at a time — or exact CTRL-F / CTRL-R surgical edits. No snippets. No partial files.
- Wife: Diana | Son: Elijah (age 9, Scout's biggest fan) | Dog: Nicolas
- Names must NEVER be hardcoded in Scout's code. Always use variables.
- Both Claude and ChatGPT are active collaborators. Cross-review between them is welcome.

2. What Scout Is

Scout is a calm family companion robot running on a Samsung Galaxy phone mounted in landscape mode as a permanent face display. Scout has animated eyes, speaks, listens, sees via camera, and remembers the family.

- Package: com.example.scoutface | Language: Kotlin + C++ NDK
- Primary test device: Samsung Galaxy A32 (stress-test, not the benchmark)
- Dev device: Samsung Galaxy Fold 7 (wireless via WiFi)
- App: \$9.99 one-time purchase on Google Play. No subscriptions. Ever.
- Brains: TinyLlama 1.1B (offline, always included) + user's own free Gemini key (online, optional)

3. Scout's Core Philosophy

Scout should feel: Calm. Thoughtful. Quietly alive. Emotionally subtle. Occasionally curious.

Scout should NOT feel: Excited. Scripted. Fake. Cartoonish. Hyperactive. Constantly praising.

Stability > Features | Presence > Intelligence | Honest > Fake cheerful | Local-first > Cloud | Predictable > Flashy

4. What Is Working Right Now

- Animated face (ScoutFaceView) — custom Canvas animation
- Speech recognition (STT) + Text-to-Speech (TTS)
- Camera — face detection, scene labeling (ML Kit)
- Gemini API integration (online brain, user's own key)
- Memory layers: TruthDb, HabitLayer, PeopleDb, JournalDb, ConversationDb
- Intent router — weather, time, greetings, family facts, downloads, IDENTITY

- TinyLlama 1.1B offline brain — VERIFIED on BOTH A32 and Fold 7
- Weather via Open-Meteo — precipitation %, offline-aware
- Identity questions hardcoded (are you my friend / can you hear me / are you happy) — NEW June 5
- Total offline mode — 'go offline' blocks ALL internet features — NEW June 5

5. Known Issues — Do Not Touch Without Discussion

Iris jitter in ScoutFaceView — A32 only (hardware-related). Fold 7 unaffected. Needs dedicated visual session.

STT name recognition — 'Scout' misheard as 'Gal', 'Scott', 'Out'. STT/phonetic issue, not TinyLlama. Separate session.

Live news — neither Gemini nor TinyLlama reads live news. A future news feed is needed. Offline, Scout returns old frozen training-data news.

Barge-in — deliberately disabled. PARKED. Do not reactivate without a full dedicated session.

CURRENT PRIORITY — update as goals shift

1. ScoutFaceView session — iris jitter (A32), mouth fix, wire in mood system
2. STT phonetic matching for wake word 'Scout' — separate session
3. Downloads should respect 'go offline' too (finish total-offline mode)
4. Response cleanup layer — post-TinyLlama filter (safety + identity + honest 'I can't keep up with live news offline')
5. Scout news feed — FUTURE feature, same clean pattern as weather
6. MainActivity cleanup and shortening — ongoing
7. Offline Brain Phase 3 — Google Play Asset Delivery

6. Working Rules — Always Apply

- Full paste-ready files only, one at a time. No snippets. No partial files.
- Surgical CTRL-F / CTRL-R edits for large files — always specify which file tab to click first.
- Some Scout files have NO indentation (flush-left). If a search fails, try a shorter unique single-line search.
- One safe change at a time. Build and test before the next change.
- Never touch speech, camera, or download systems without explicit discussion.
- Never touch ScoutFaceView casually — it is Scout's visual heart.
- Patrick is not a professional programmer — screenshot-level explanations always.

This Quick Start is the session-opener. For full architecture, NDK discoveries, business decisions, and technical reference — upload the Scout Master Summary.